



R.C. BHARGAVA
CHAIRMAN, MARUTI
SUZUKI INDIA, AT ITS
AGM THIS YEAR

“Electric vehicles are likely to be adopted gradually over the years as the multiple challenges facing the consumers are overcome”



RAJESH JEJURIKAR
ED (AUTO & FARM
SECTOR), MAHINDRA
& MAHINDRA

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as more and more players join, the market will grow.

Tata Motors tested the BaaS model by giving battery subscriptions for 12 months, 24 months, and 36 months, but the model did not get traction as car buyers got confused. “We are always open to experimenting and piloting new ideas. We had tested the BaaS option about three-four years back and found that it was confusing customers. While physically the battery and the vehicle are not separated, financially the pricing model was separating them. It was not easy for customers to understand this and so we decided not to proceed with it,” says Chandra.

Rajesh Jejurikar, Executive Director (auto & farm sector) of M&M, is open to any disruptive idea to help the country reach the same goal. “India is on the cusp of

the evolution of a new category. We are open to experimenting and learning from any new disruptive idea that enables industry growth,” says Jejurikar.

BETTING ON LOCALISATION

Automakers are doing everything to localise production and build reliable supply chains. China is the global hub for EV components, especially lithium-ion cells. Tata Motors buys its LFP-based type of lithium-ion cells from China but gets lithium-ion battery packs from Tata AutoComp Systems Ltd and a non-Tata company. “We are working with multiple supplier partners to source battery packs. Adopting such a multi-sourcing strategy hedges supply chain risks, mitigates dependency on a single supplier and improves competitiveness for timely and seamless supply of required parts,” says Chandra.

The next step: buy lithium-ion cell battery packs made by Tata outfits. “In the future we will also source battery packs from Agratas, a Tata group company. They will also be investing in cell development and technology research and recycling,” says Chandra.

JSW MG is aiming for a localisation level of 80-85% by using cells and battery packs from the recently announced battery manufacturing plant by JSW Group. The Chinese automaker is aiming to localise steel components, specialty steel and some intricate component through its partnership with JSW Group.

M&M is looking at global leaders for a consistent supply chain for lithium-ion batteries. “We are also committed to ensuring responsible recycling and disposal of lithium-ion batteries,” says Jejurikar.

FIRST MOVER TATA WAY AHEAD

For Tata Motors, a truck-maker for decades before it began making passenger cars in 1991, EVs have given it growth. Before introducing EVs, Tata Motors’ market share in passenger cars was in single digits (6-7% in 2018-19). EVs helped it get a 13-14% share in 2023, making it the third-largest passenger vehicles (PV) manufacturer.

By 2024, Tata Motors had graduated from being seen as a ‘taxicab’ maker because of its Indigo model. Today, it has the widest range of EVs: the Tigor.ev, Tiago.ev, Punch.ev, Nexon.ev and Curvv.ev. Its EV sales surged by 43%, giving it a market share of over 70% in the segment, while its overall portfolio grew by 6% on the back of its EV lineup.

At Tata Motors’ 79th annual general meeting (AGM) in June this year, Chairman N. Chandrasekaran said the company’s EV business will focus on driving up